NEW CITY LIGHT
LIGHTING THE WAY

Symbol concepts

Proposals only. None of these replaces the master artwork until NCL approves it.

FOR REVIEW · OCTOBER 2026

WHY

The symbol on its own

Next to the wordmark the logo is clearly New City Light. On its own (app icon, avatar, favicon) an orange radiating star with an empty centre looks like the “spark” marks used by several tech and AI brands. Most people see the symbol alone at small sizes, so that is where the likeness matters most.



BEFORE · WHITE ON ORANGE · RETIRED



NOW · ORANGE ON NAVY · PRIMARY

DONE ALREADY, NO LOGO CHANGE

- **Navy app icon** is now the primary icon and favicon. The guidelines are updated.
- **White-on-orange tile retired** for icons and avatars. It is the closest match to other spark marks.
- Use the **full lockup** wherever there is room. The likeness only appears when the symbol stands alone.

STILL OPEN

- Should the symbol itself change? The next pages show six colour-only options, six shape changes from the master geometry and four geometric concepts.
- Before the ® is relied on, have a trademark attorney run a clearance search on whichever symbol is chosen.

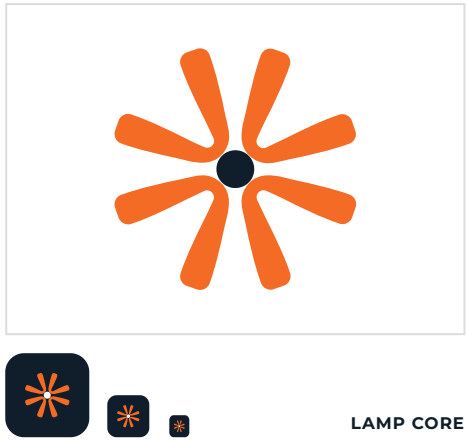
OVERVIEW

Seven symbols side by side

The master plus six alternatives. Each one is shown with its navy icon at 64, 32 and 16 px. Judge them at the smallest size first: that is where the problem is.



MASTER (CURRENT)



LAMP CORE



TWO-TONE



PINWHEEL



BEAMS



RISING LIGHT

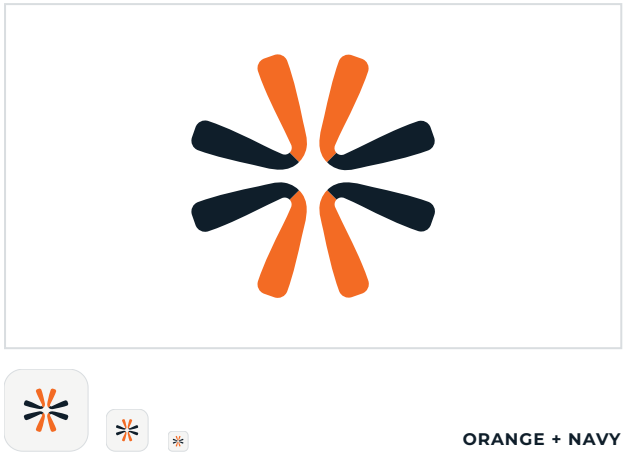


LENS

COLOUR ONLY

Same symbol, new colours

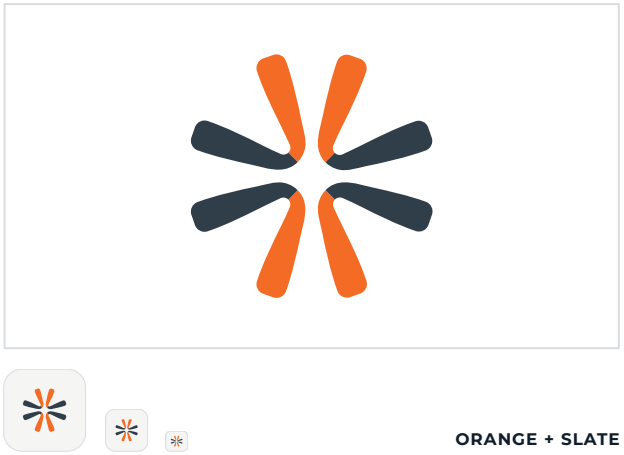
No change to the shape, so every existing file, the stamp and the pattern stay valid. Colour does most of the work on screens and in full-colour print. In one-colour uses (stamp, embossing) the shape is unchanged, so the likeness stays there.



ORANGE + NAVY



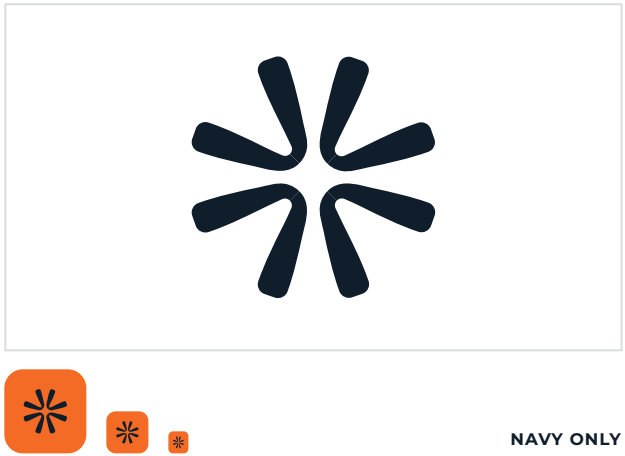
NAVY + ORANGE



ORANGE + SLATE



ORANGE + WHITE ON NAVY



NAVY ONLY



ORANGE ON NAVY

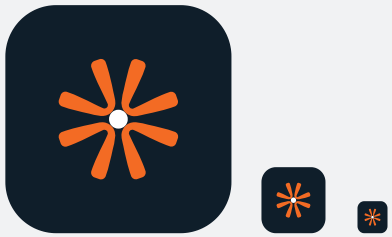
CONCEPT B

Lamp core

A solid dot fills the empty centre: a light source the petals radiate from. Smallest possible change.



ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX

ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

Low

FOR

Tiny change; keeps all existing artwork recognisable. Gives the symbol a clear meaning: a light source.

AGAINST

Still an eight-ray starburst. Helps, does not solve.

Built from the master petal geometry with no redrawing. A designer should refine curves, weights and spacing before anything is final.

CONCEPT C

Two-tone

Vertical petals in orange, horizontal petals in navy. Ties the symbol to the wordmark colour; no single-colour spark reads like this.



ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX

ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

Medium–high

FOR

Navy ties the symbol to the wordmark. Same geometry, so every existing application still works.

AGAINST

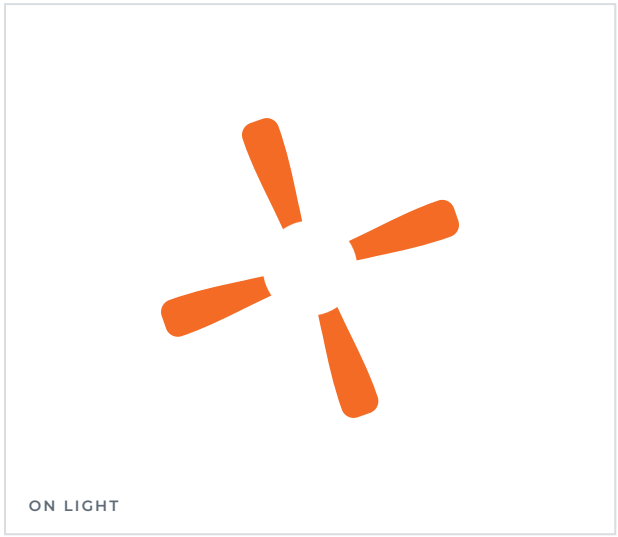
Only works in colour. One-colour uses (stamp, embossing, bag) fall back to the master.

Built from the master petal geometry with no redrawing. A designer should refine curves, weights and spacing before anything is final.

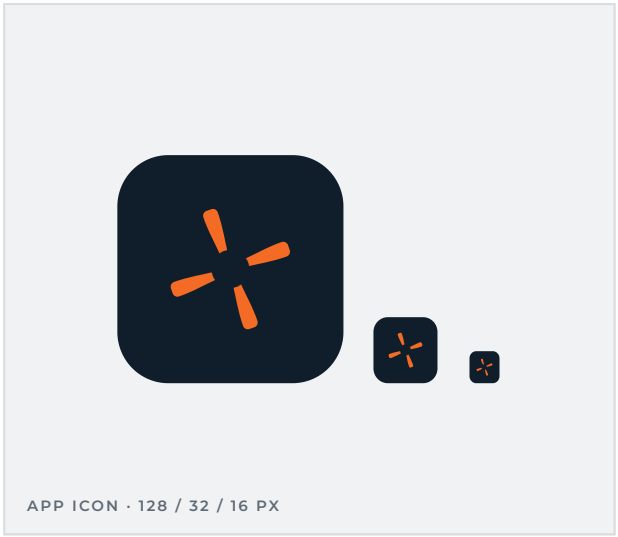
CONCEPT D

Pinwheel

One petal from each pair, in rotation. Four blades read as motion and a turbine, not a spark.



ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX



ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

High

FOR

Clear break. Reads as motion, energy, a turbine.

AGAINST

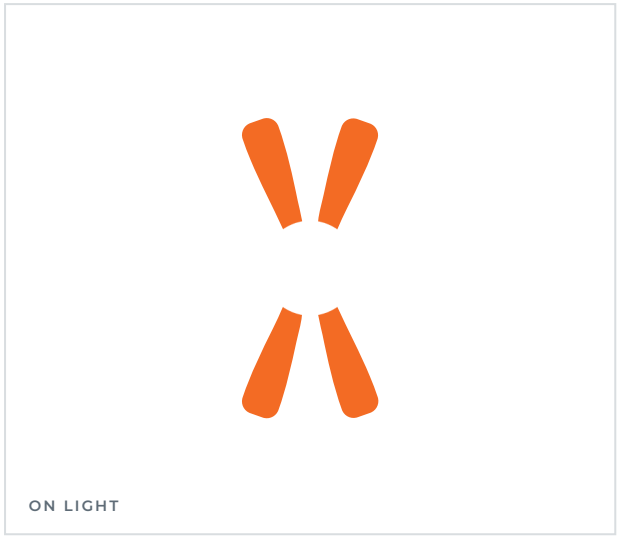
Can read as a fan, which is the wrong product for a lighting company. Thin bases at small sizes.

Built from the master petal geometry with no redrawing. A designer should refine curves, weights and spacing before anything is final.

CONCEPT E

Beams

Only the vertical petals: light thrown up and down like a wall washer. Strong silhouette at favicon size.



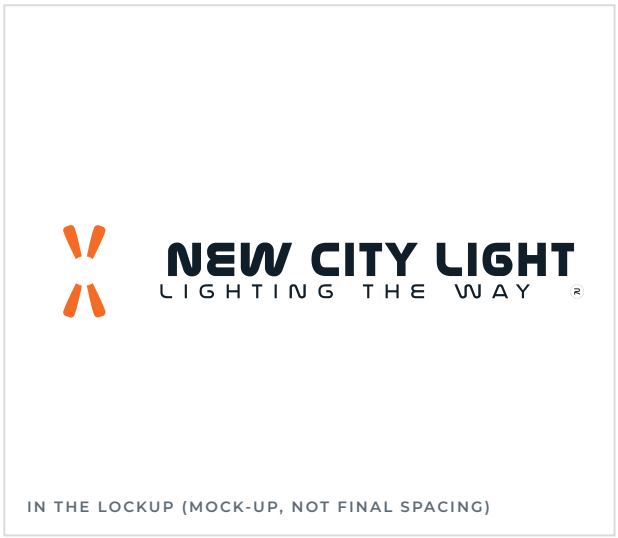
ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX



ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

High

FOR

Bold, simple silhouette; survives a 16 px favicon.

AGAINST

Loses the radiance of the original. Can read as an hourglass or an “X”.

Built from the master petal geometry with no redrawing. A designer should refine curves, weights and spacing before anything is final.

CONCEPT F

Rising light

Top half of the symbol over a horizon bar: light rising over the city. Closest to “Lighting the Way”.



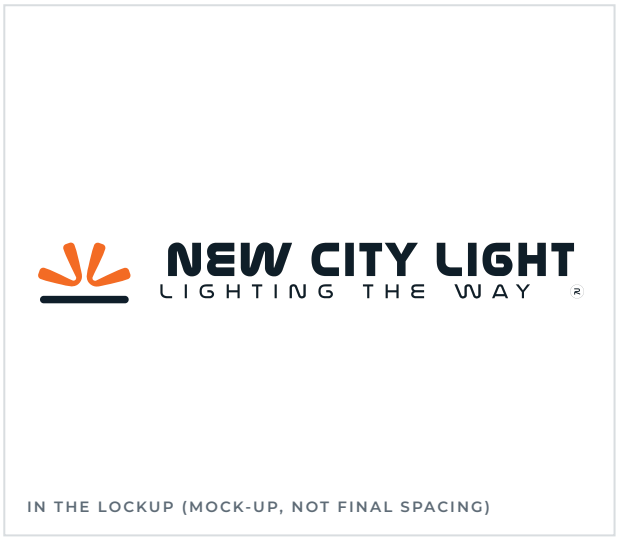
ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX



ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

High

FOR

Most on-message: light rising over the city, “Lighting the Way”. Distinctive in the lockup.

AGAINST

Wide, not square, so weaker as an app icon. Sunrise marks are common in other sectors.

Built from the master petal geometry with no redrawing. A designer should refine curves, weights and spacing before anything is final.

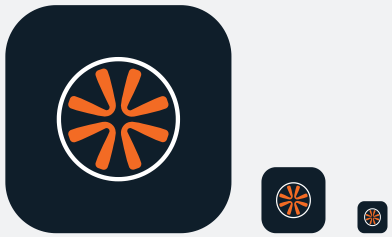
CONCEPT G

Lens

The master symbol held inside a thin ring, like a luminaire seen from below. Encloses the mark so it stops reading as a loose spark.



ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX



ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

Medium

FOR

Encloses the mark so it becomes a badge, like a luminaire seen from below. Good for seals and signage.

AGAINST

The ring disappears at favicon size, where the likeness is worst.

Built from the master petal geometry with no redrawing. A designer should refine curves, weights and spacing before anything is final.

GEOMETRIC DIRECTION

Cut from a closed shape

Built from the reference boards: petals cut out of a circle or rounded square by straight gaps, with a round U joining each pair and an open centre. A closed outline reads as a badge, not a loose spark: the furthest move from the current look. The references are other studios' work; these use their principles, not their marks.





APERTURE



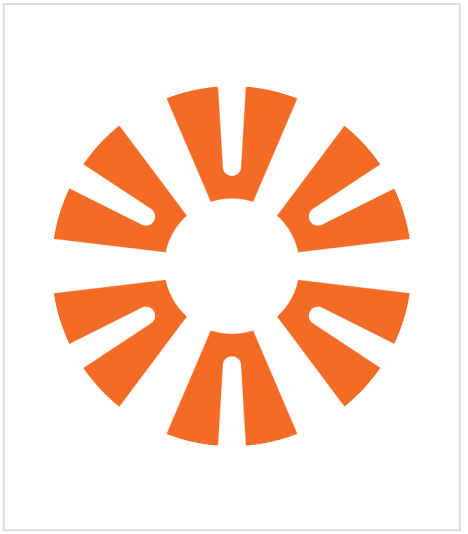


WINDOW





SOLID DISC





SUNBURST









CONCEPT H

Aperture

Eight petals cut from a disc, joined in four U-shaped pairs around a round opening. Reads as a lens or a downlight seen from below.



ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX



ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

High

FOR

A closed circle reads as a badge, not a loose spark. Looks like a lens or a downlight from below, so it means lighting. Keeps NCL's eight petals in four pairs.

AGAINST

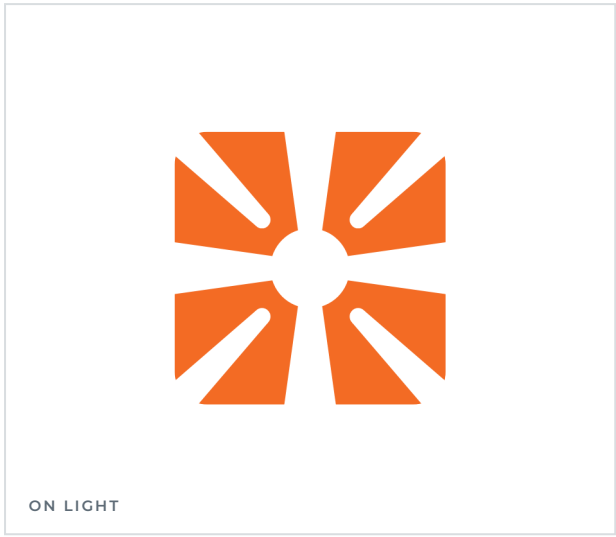
Segmented-circle marks are a current trend, so it needs refining to feel like NCL's own. Can read as a camera shutter.

New geometry: a circle or square cut by parametric gaps. A starting point, not artwork; a designer should set final proportions, gap widths and corner rounding.

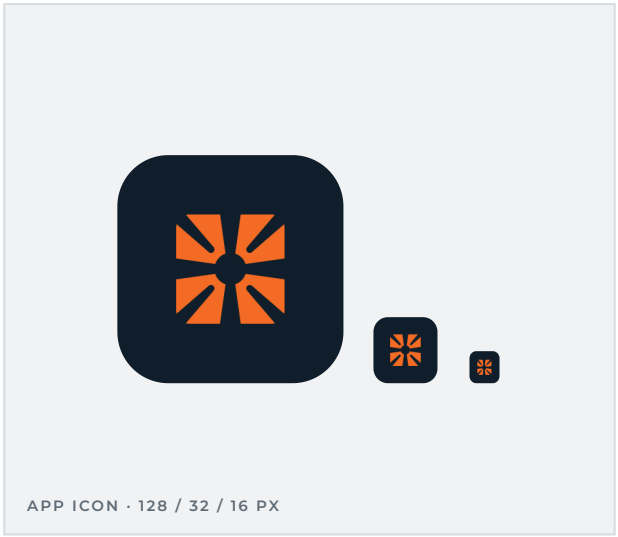
CONCEPT I

Window

The same cut from a rounded square: a lit window, a city block. Squares sit well next to the wordmark and on an app tile.



ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX



ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

High

FOR

Square silhouette fills an app tile and matches the blocky wordmark. Suggests a lit window or a city block: the “City” in the name.

AGAINST

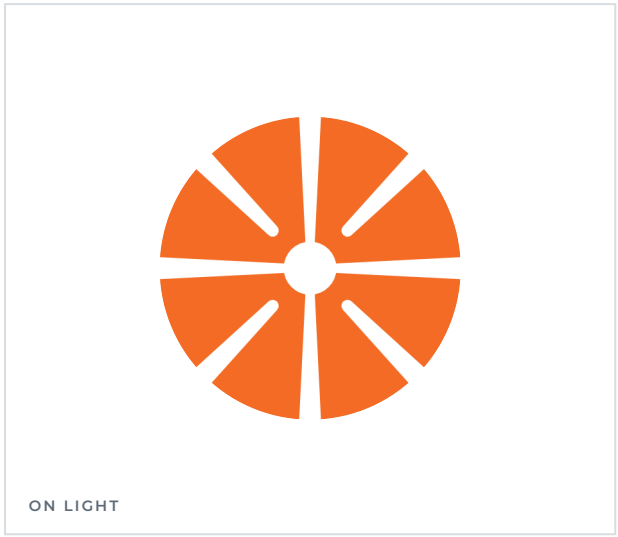
Less radiant than the circle. At 16 px it can read as a plain window or grid icon.

New geometry: a circle or square cut by parametric gaps. A starting point, not artwork; a designer should set final proportions, gap widths and corner rounding.

CONCEPT J

Solid disc

Heavier: narrow cuts and a small opening, so the mark reads as one solid badge. Strongest at 16 px; prints well as a stamp.



ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX



ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

High

FOR

The most solid version: clearest at 16 px, prints cleanly as a stamp or embossing.

AGAINST

Heaviest and least like light. Can read as a pie, a fan or an air vent.

New geometry: a circle or square cut by parametric gaps. A starting point, not artwork; a designer should set final proportions, gap widths and corner rounding.

CONCEPT K

Sunburst

Twelve petals in six pairs. More radiance, closer to a light source; still a closed circle, not a loose spark.



ON LIGHT



APP ICON · 128 / 32 / 16 PX

ON NAVY



IN THE LOCKUP (MOCK-UP, NOT FINAL SPACING)

DISTANCE FROM GENERIC SPARK MARKS

High

FOR

The most radiant of the closed marks: a light source seen head-on.

AGAINST

Twelve cuts fill in below 32 px. Sun marks are common in solar and energy, which is close to NCL's market.

New geometry: a circle or square cut by parametric gaps. A starting point, not artwork; a designer should set final proportions, gap widths and corner rounding.

RECOMMENDATION

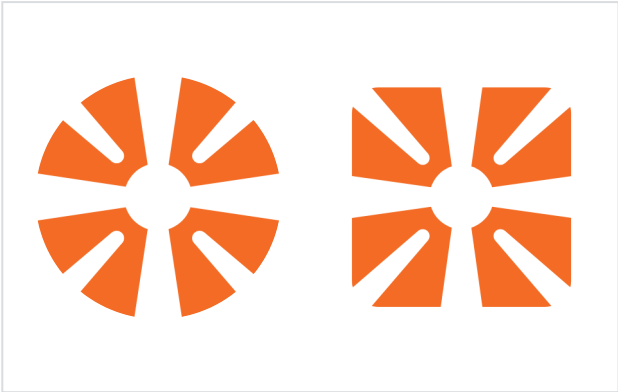
What we would do

Keep the navy icon (done). Then pick one of two routes, depending on how far NCL wants to move. The geometric direction is the stronger fix.



Route 1 · Two-tone

Lowest risk. Same symbol, recoloured. No reprint of one-colour items (stamp, bag). Business cards, signage and digital pick it up at the next print run.



Route 2 · Aperture or Window

A real break that keeps NCL's eight petals in four pairs. Aperture says lighting; Window says city and suits the app tile. Needs a designer's pass, new lockups and a full artwork update, so it is only worth it if NCL is early in the rollout.

BEFORE DECIDING

- Show the shortlist to a few customers at icon size and ask what they see.
- Have a designer refine the chosen option. These are built from the master geometry, not finished artwork.
- Trademark clearance search on the chosen symbol (lighting is a different class from software, but check).
- Update the master files, then rebuild this pack: *python3 build/build_all.py*.